

Elbow Pain - Male (Adult)

Algorithm 1449 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Male

Definition

- UAT-only adult and pediatric non-traumatic elbow-pain pathway screening for joint infection, systemic illness and neurovascular compromise before in-person assessment.
- Adult patient.
- Male.

Initial assessment

1. [LOCATION] Where exactly is the pain?
2. [DURATION] How long has the pain lasted?
3. [YES_NO] Is the skin around the elbow swollen and hot?
4. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the age; is there pregnancy/postpartum status, systemic illness, immune risk, recent infection/procedure, hidden trauma, neurovascular change, or child safeguarding concern?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Motor Vehicle Accident

Did this problem begin with a motor vehicle crash or as part of a multi-system crash injury?

A motor vehicle crash or multi-system crash injury belongs in the Motor Vehicle Accident pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Is elbow pain severe with neurovascular change, or is there a hot swollen joint plus marked systemic illness, confusion, breathing change, collapse or rapid deterioration?

Neurovascular compromise or a hot joint with marked systemic deterioration requires emergency assessment through the Qatar pathway.

1. Disposition level 70

With no emergency feature, is there any persistent or unexplained elbow pain, hot swelling, functional limitation, child joint concern or higher-risk context?

This UAT pathway requires in-person assessment and does not authorize remote diagnosis or fixed medication advice.

Advice

Qatar emergency elbow-joint response

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 for a hot swollen joint with systemic illness, severe pain, neurovascular change, or rapid deterioration. Do not allow self-driving or force movement. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: increasing swelling or redness; fever or systemic illness.

In-person elbow assessment

- Arrange in-person assessment through an approved Qatar adult or pediatric pathway. Use wrapped cold briefly if comfortable; avoid fixed-dose medication advice until patient factors are checked.
- Call Back If: pain worsens; swelling, redness or fever.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 for a hot swollen joint with systemic illness, severe pain, neurovascular change, or rapid deterioration. Do not allow self-driving or force movement. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Joint pain" (non-injury pain guidance), <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/joint-pain/> (page last reviewed 26 February 2026) - applied to non-traumatic elbow pain

Provenance

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